

Joshua Zachariah

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity Engineer and Computer Engineering student with experience across security consulting, GRC, IAM, cloud security, security operations, and security automation. Built and launched a cyber risk early-engagement program at PayPal and deployed Microsoft Entra ID governance across enterprise environments. Experienced with security workflow automation, product security reviews, NIST, MITRE ATT&CK, and AI-assisted security workflows. ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity.

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Dallas

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

• **Achievements:** Academic Excellence Scholarship recipient (AES)

May 2027

Richardson, TX

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PayPal

May 2026 - Aug 2026

Cybersecurity Engineer Intern

Scottsdale, AZ

- Built and launched PayPal's company-wide Early Engagement program, shifting security left in the product development lifecycle by surfacing security, privacy, and cyber risk before formal product review; took the program from concept to production in 12 weeks and reduced Security Consulting workload by 48% for one of its highest-volume ticket types.
- Led cross-functional Product Change Reviews for customer-facing payment and AI features, coordinating product, engineering, security, privacy, and risk teams to identify launch dependencies, assign accountable owners, and resolve escalations.
- Redesigned 7 Security Consulting workflows spanning data movement, firewalls, identity, SaaS, and third-party risk, applying security orchestration and workflow automation to reduce repetitive discovery and consultant effort.
- Secured alignment from 30+ global security and business stakeholders, obtained production approval, and established cross-team ownership to sustain the program beyond the internship.
- Designed agent-ready Security Consulting workflows and Jira-ready intake patterns for multi-step risk analysis, BISO routing, escalation, and workflow migration, establishing the foundation for agentic automation.

Clyde Companies (Contract via JJZAC LLC)

Feb 2026 - May 2026; Aug 2026 - Present

IAM Security Engineer

Remote

- Design and deploy enterprise-wide Microsoft Entra ID Entitlement Management, standardizing authentication, authorization, multistage approvals, and identity lifecycle governance for 5,000+ users across 300+ enterprise applications.
- Conduct access reviews and identity lifecycle governance using Microsoft Entra ID Identity Governance and Microsoft Graph, standardizing access-package configurations across a portfolio of 400+ enterprise applications.
- Develop Microsoft Graph, PowerShell, and Azure Logic Apps automation for access-review notifications and access-governance workflows, while documenting IAM configuration, approval logic, and operating procedures for long-term maintenance.

Insurity

Oct 2025 - Jan 2026

Associate AI Developer

Remote

- Delivered machine learning services within core insurance product workflows (billing, payments, policy management) following secure development and SDLC best practices, integrating with Microsoft SQL Server and cloud infrastructure.
- Collaborated in Agile teams using Azure DevOps and Jira to ship production features, remediate security risks, and meet regulatory and compliance requirements.

EdMe (IIT Bombay-incubated)

Jun 2025 – May 2026; Aug 2026 - Present

Security and AI/ML Research Engineer Intern

Remote

- Lead security strategy for AI/ML data pipelines, embedding GDPR, COPPA, and DPDP compliance into workflows and designing secure access control models to strengthen risk management across cloud-hosted environments.
- Build scalable Neo4j and MongoDB architectures and a hybrid AI/ML framework with hallucination mitigation, supporting real-time personalization for high-volume concurrent users.

Best Buy

Oct 2023 – May 2026; Aug 2026 - Present

Technology Sales Consultant, Computing Department Lead

Garland, TX

- Achieve a Top 0.01% nationwide ranking through technical problem-solving, data-driven decision-making, and clear communication that bridges business and technical needs.
- Earn recognition as the #1 most valuable employee in the market by leveraging Tableau and Power BI to analyze KPIs, optimize operations, and deliver measurable results.

Rice University

Jul 2023 - Aug 2023

IoT Research Intern

Houston, TX

- Built secure, scalable IoT data pipelines in Rust with real-time streaming, developing programming abstractions for fault tolerance and compliance across healthcare and industrial domains.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Security Operations Center (SOC) Lab

- Built a multi-VM penetration testing and SOC lab on AWS EC2 using Kali Linux, Ubuntu, and Windows hosts, integrating Splunk SIEM, Suricata IDS, and pfSense firewall to assess vulnerabilities, monitor network traffic, and detect threats.
- Executed MITRE ATT&CK adversary emulations and digital forensic investigations using host and network telemetry to test detection pipelines and incident response workflows; built custom Splunk dashboards and correlation rules for threat monitoring and alerting.

Thevenin AI | AI STEM Solver [Available on the App Store](#)

- Architected secure cloud infrastructure for an AI STEM platform serving 600+ monthly active users (MAU), formally recommended for student use by departments at UTD and SMU; protected LLM endpoints with rate limiting and Google Cloud Secret Manager, and engineered Firebase authentication and RBAC to prevent unauthorized access.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Security Domains:** Security Operations, Incident Response, Network Security, Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC), Cloud and Infrastructure Security, Application Security, Data Security, Vulnerability Management, Identity and Access Management (IAM)
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Entra ID Identity Governance, Entitlement Management, Active Directory, AWS IAM, MFA, RBAC, Authentication and Authorization, Microsoft Graph
- **SIEM and Detection:** Splunk SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender, Sysmon, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61, Threat Detection, Correlation and Analytics Rules, Vulnerability Assessment, Wireshark, Malware Analysis, Digital Forensics, Penetration Testing
- **Network Security & Cryptography:** IDS/IPS (Suricata, Snort), Firewalls (pfSense), TLS/SSL, AES, TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, VLANs, Network Segmentation
- **Cloud, DevOps, AI & Automation:** AWS, Azure, Azure Logic Apps, Security Orchestration and Workflow Automation, Kubernetes, CI/CD, Git/GitHub, Jira, ServiceNow, Interactive AI Tooling, Agentic AI, LangGraph, Secure Development and SDLC, Docker
- **Programming and Scripting:** Python, C/C++, Java, Bash, PowerShell, JavaScript, SQL, Rust, C#, JSON
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST, ISO 27001/27002, PCI-DSS, HIPAA, GDPR, COPPA, DPDP, NIST Cybersecurity Framework
- **Operating Systems:** MacOS, Linux, Windows

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **NCSF National Cyber Scholar Award:** Ranked in the Top 2% of 45,000+ competitors nationwide for excellence in cybersecurity challenges (CyberStart America, Feb 2024).
- **#1 Amazon New Release Author:** The Digital Odyssey: Navigating the Impact of Technology (AI, Cybersecurity, and Digital Transformation, Aug 2023). [View Book on Amazon](#)
- **Co-Author, Pumping Life:** The Power of Your Heart (Jan 2026). [View Book on Amazon](#)

ORGANIZATIONS

Stanford University Code in Place

Section Leader

- Taught a global cohort through a 6-week introductory Python and CS program with weekly instruction and live debugging (2026).

Coding Central

Founder and President

- Global STEM nonprofit serving 5,000+ students; partners include Microsoft, Google, and Garland ISD.

Garland ISD Career Technical Education Panel

- Advise on Cybersecurity, IT, Software Engineering, and AI pathways for 50,000+ students.